observed that "nomadic tribal communities have been an important factor in Islamic and Persianate history down to the present," but went on to retain the distinction between "Arab (tribal, Sunni) and Persian (urban, Shi'i)" (*ibid.*, 308). Rather, re-examining these broad and largely artificial divisions requires investigation of how nomadic groups in fact *transcended* them – a transcendence amply evidenced throughout the "the Persianate millennium."

27. Cf. Biran 2004; Biran 2005: 94ff., 196 and *passim*; Bosworth 2010; McClary 2020: 7ff.
28. Bosworth, 1961, 1965, 1973, 1992; Pazhvak 1968: 90, 94–95; O'Neal 2016a.
29. Thomas (2018: 29) rightly eschewed the otherwise perspicacious C. E. Bosworth's historically anachronistic term of "buffer state" to refer to the coalescing Shansabanis of the first half of the twelfth century: the phrase was first used only in the late nineteenth century to describe the status of the then Durrani–Pashtun kingdom of Afghanistan *vis-à-vis* Britain and Czarist Russia in the so-called Great Game; moreover, while the Shansabanis' homelands of seasonal transhumance were technically sandwiched in between the Saljuqs and the Ghaznavids, their early territorial presence was far from bounded and fixed, as the modern term would imply. Nevertheless, the term was used again to refer to the Balkh region in the seventh century: cf. de al Vassière 2020: 127.
30. Cf. Durand-Guédy 2013a, 2013b. Following the same author (2018), it is important to highlight the integration of the luxurious trellis tent (Pers. *khargah*) – initially associated with "Turanian" or Turkic contexts of the Eurasian steppe lands – as a part of the visual and textual description of power in western Eurasia's Perso-Islamic courts by the eleventh century. While this incorporation surely signaled mobility and agility as a part of royalty (cf. *infra* in main text and Chapter 3), "[i]n Iran the *khargah* remained exclusively a status symbol … not imply[ing] a change of lifestyle: the urban location of the Iranian court" (*ibid.*, 835). See also *infra* in main text and notes.
31. Bosworth 1961: 118.
32. See Gellner 1983: 446; also Introduction and Chapter 4**.**
33. Peacock 2010: 122–23; Peacock 2015: 25ff. See also this author's discussion of the Christian author Bar Hebraeus – who drew upon the *Malik-nama* tradition, like his counterparts of the Perso-Arabic histories – and therein the motivations behind Saljuq conversion to Islam (*ibid.*, 246–247). A parallel Muslim-convert progenitor figure was Satuq Bughra Khan (mid-tenth century) of the Qarakhanids (cf. Bosworth 2010: 22).
34. Cf. Peacock 2015: e.g., 39, 48.
35. Spooner 2019: 301.
36. See Durand-Guédy 2013b for the Saljuq period's "clear break with the past" especially in terms of the spatial organization of power. Cf. also Chapter 3.
37. See esp. Blair 1992: 160–161; and Lambton and Sourdel-Thomine 2008: 167–170, 172–174.
38. For the Isfahan *jami'*, see Blair 1992: 160–167; Hillenbrand 2015. For the example of the *Chihil Dukhtaran minar*, cf. Smith 1936: 318–323; Y. Godard 1936: 361–363.
39. For Gar, see Smith 1936: 323–337; Y. Godard 1936: 363. For Sin: Smith 1936: